Hon MEC SIBULELE NGONGO
Dept of Sport, Recreation, Arts and Culture

LIBRARIES OF THE FUTURE EXPO

South African Library Week 2026
Provincial Celebrations
East London Convention Centre, KuGompo City -BCM.

"RECLAIMING KNOWLEDGE EMPOWERING FUTURES"

16-18 March 2026 Starting @ 08:30 Daily

Day One:16/03/26 -
Envisioning the Future of Libraries

- **Opening Ceremony**
  Keynote speech by MEC, highlighting the role of libraries in society and the Purpose of the Expo.
- **Panel Discussion: "Libraries in a Digital Age"**
  Academics, ICT experts, and library practitioners discuss the integration of digital tools in libraries and the future role of libraries.
- **Opening of exhibitions**
  Technology Showcase: Innovations in Library Services Hands-on demonstrations from ICT stakeholders on emerging technologies and tools that libraries can integrate, such as virtual reality, digital cataloguing, and online databases.
- **Networking Lunch**
  An opportunity for participants to connect and discuss potential collaborations.
- **Break away Sessions**
  Session 1: "Digital Literacy and Lifelong Learning" – Exploring programs that empower communities to develop digital skills.
  Session 2: "Libraries as Cultural and Community Hubs" – Showcasing libraries as spaces for local culture, storytelling, and community events.

Closure: Day One

Day Two: 17/ 03/26 -
Building a collaborative future

- **Opening & Welcome**
  Feedback from Day1 breakaway sessions
- **Presentation: by Prof Modiba**
  Topic: Pathways to apply artificial Intelligence tools to enhance user experience in libraries 5.0
- **Interactive Workshop:**
  Digital Transformation in Libraries
  Practical sessions led by ICT experts on integrating digital tools and improving library services with technology.
- **Roundtable Discussions:**
  Cross-sector Collaboration
  Representatives of papers from universities, ICT companies, and government departments discuss strategies for improving access to resources and supporting library staff.
- **Exhibitions:**
  Exhibits from various institutions and technology providers, showcasing tools, resources, and programs to enhance library services.

Closure: Day 2

DAY Three:18/03/2026 –
Crafting of the libraries of the future

- **Closing ceremony**
- **Feedback from breakaway sessions**
- **Success stories: Library of the year 2025 –** (Kirkwood Public Library)
- **Training of librarians** (Parallel sessions)

'A United, Active and Winning Province Through Sport, Recreation, Arts, Culture & Heritage'

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